

N.Y. case’s coda just latest twist for Trump

Sentencing 10 days ahead of swearing-in highlights unusual return to power

BY MARIANNE LEVINE

Days before his second inauguration, President-elect Donald Trump faces the uncomfortable prospect of appearing — in person or virtually — before a New York state judge to be sentenced for his 34 felony convictions for falsifying business records to cover up a hush money payment to an adult-film actress.

The court appearance, scheduled for Friday, offers yet another reminder of the legal woes that dogged Trump as he mounted his third bid for the White House. It also cements a distinction that he shares with none of his predecessors: He will be the first serving president who is also a felon. No previous president has been convicted of a felony, let alone summoned before a judge just days before their inauguration.

While New York Supreme Court Justice Juan Merchan said he will not sentence Trump to jail time, the appearance will be an opportunity for the judge to denounce what he has called the “premeditated and continuous deception by the leader of the free world.”

“It’s a reminder that we live, politically speaking, in a split-screen America,” said Tim Naftali, senior research scholar at Columbia University’s School of International and Public Affairs. “For some Americans, [Trump’s] legal difficulties were a reason to vote for him because it deepened their sense that they, like him, were victims.”

“The fact that the procession to the inauguration will include yet

SEE TRUMP ON A5

The Sunday Take: This time, Trump faces a more dangerous world. **A2**

Neighbors bid farewell as the 39th president’s motorcade winds through rural Georgia: ‘He was one of us before he became one for everyone’



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Carter’s final trip begins in the place where it all started

BY HOLLY BAILEY, LORI ROZSA AND JIM LYNN
IN ATLANTA

The hearse carrying the casket of former president Jimmy Carter passes through his hometown of Plains, Georgia, on Saturday on its way to Atlanta.

The nation began its formal farewell to Jimmy Carter on Saturday, as the casket carrying the former president started its journey along the rural roads of south Georgia, where he spent much of his life, and onward to Atlanta, where his body will lie in public repose ahead of a state funeral in Washington this week.

The events marked the first of a multiday celebration of Carter, who died last Sunday at his home in Plains, the tiny town of his childhood and the launchpad for his storied political career. After a painful defeat in the 1980 election that ousted him from the White House, he returned there with wife Rosalynn and reinvented himself as global humanitarian and champion of democracy.

Residents of Plains and admirers from afar turned out to honor him Saturday morning. Carter’s casket emerged shortly after 10:20 a.m. from Phoebe Sumter Medical

Center in Americus, about 10 miles from his hometown, where his body had been since his death Dec. 29 at age 100.

Under a crystal-clear sky, Carter’s casket, draped in an American flag, was escorted by current and former members of his Secret Service detail to a waiting hearse. It was a detail the late president had requested to honor those who had protected him and his family over the decades, and who were considered “lifelong friends,” according to memorial organizers.

Watching were several members of the Carter family, including his children, Jack, Chip, Jeff and Amy, in their first public appearance since their father’s death.

Among those observing the ceremony were dozens of hospital employees. The small rural

SEE CARTER ON A7

In 1980: Moscow Olympics boycott left American athletes stunned. **D1**

States’ rules led to ‘cartels’ in health care, litigants say

Start-ups see stifled competition, but officials insist edicts help patients

BY SHANNON NAJMABADI

In 2017, M’Moupientila “Marc” N’da sought state approval to drive older and disabled Nebraskans to doctor’s appointments. Given what he was seeing among clients of his home health business — who often complained about unreliable rides — the need seemed obvious.

But would-be competitors protested, backed by laws that give them sway over new entrants to the market. Though state regulators determined N’da was qualified to run a medical transport operation, they denied his application because he hadn’t demonstrated it would be “harmless” to the businesses that had come before him.

N’da responded with a lawsuit accusing the state of denying him due process. The case is now before the Nebraska Supreme Court.

N’da is part of a wave of litigants pressing to dismantle regulations that plaintiff lawyers say have fomented health-care “cartels” in more than 30 states — limiting, for example, the number of methadone clinics in West Virginia,

youth mental health beds in Arkansas and MRI centers in North Carolina.

These certificate-of-need (CON) laws require certain health care and transportation businesses to demonstrate community need for their services before they can operate. The prerequisite is meant to contain costs and prevent oversaturation of the market, but it often comes with a catch: Would-be competitors can challenge applicants whose services could cut into their sales.

“It creates these little fiefdoms,” said William Aronin, a lawyer with the Institute for Justice, the libertarian law firm representing N’da. “No one benefits but the incumbents.”

Health-care officials say the rules create a crucial buffer in a system not governed by the usual tenets of a free-market economy. Hospitals must care for emergency room patients regardless of their ability to pay. The government sets payment rates for patients on public insurance programs. Commercially insured patients and specialty services help subsidize those losses.

If an ambulatory surgical center set up shop next to a rural hospital, “it can cherry-pick the patients that it wants,” said David Dirr, a lawyer who has represented the Kentucky Hospital Association.

SEE CERTIFICATES ON A13



MICHAEL E. MILLER/THE WASHINGTON POST

Australia, wary of China, dives into preparations for building nuclear subs

Ollie Filipponi always thought he’d be an electrician. But then the 16-year-old started at Findon Technical College, a new high school where the curriculum is partly designed by a defense contractor and the welding bays are modeled on those at the local naval shipyard.

Now the curly-haired teen dreams of building nuclear-

powered submarines. “That’s way cooler than wiring houses,” he said.

Ollie is one of the early beneficiaries of AUKUS, the trilateral security pact in which the United States and the United Kingdom are helping Australia build nuclear-propelled submarines to counter China’s growing military

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SEE SUBMARINES ON A16

From left, Ollie Filipponi, Isla Taylor and Matt Goldsworthy do a metalworking project at Findon Technical College.

METRO
D.C. is on a heightened security footing ahead of Trump’s inauguration.

SPORTS
When he’s on the run, Jayden Daniels is as dangerous as it gets.



ARTS & STYLE
Inside “Sesame Street” as the venerable TV show fights to survive.

TRAVEL
Florida glamping with cats awaits at (wait for it) Purradise Springs.



BOOK WORLD
Adam Ross’s novel about a N.Y. teen’s fateful year is worth the long wait.

BUSINESS
Boeing’s 2024 plans came unhinged, starting with four missing bolts.

Mayhem prompts stricter security

U.S.: ‘COPYCAT’ ATTACKS POSSIBLE

New Year’s rampage, truck blast stoke fears

BY MARIA SACCHETTI,
ELLIE SILVERMAN,
MARK MASKE
AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

The deadly New Year’s Day attack in New Orleans by a man driving a pickup truck and an electric vehicle explosion in Las Vegas the same day have prompted law enforcement officials nationwide to increase security, issue fresh safety warnings and reassess preparations ahead of events that could be targeted for violence.

The FBI, Department of Homeland Security and U.S. National Counterterrorism Center on Friday warned about possible copycat attacks in a security bulletin after an Army veteran from Texas rammed a truck into New Year’s revelers in the early-morning hours of Jan. 1, fatally injuring at least 14 people on Bourbon Street in New Orleans.

In a statement, DHS urged the public to promptly report suspicious activity and “remain vigilant of potential copycat or retaliatory attacks inspired by the New Orleans terrorist attack or other recent, vehicle-ramming incidents across the globe.”

The warning came as officials from coast to coast gear up for events such as the Golden Globes awards in Los Angeles, the Super Bowl in New Orleans and events in Washington, D.C. — the presidential election certification on Monday, the memorial service for President Jimmy Carter on Thursday and Donald Trump’s inauguration as president on Jan. 20.

SEE SECURITY ON A12

In Cybertruck blast’s wake, unease at cars’ data collection

BY SHANNON NAJMABADI
AND TRISHA THADANI

Video footage and other data collected by Tesla helped law enforcement quickly piece together how a Cybertruck came to explode outside the Trump International Hotel in Las Vegas on New Year’s Day.

The trove of digital evidence also served as a high-profile demonstration of how much data modern cars collect about their drivers and those around them.

Data privacy experts say the investigation — which has determined that the driver, active-duty U.S. Army soldier Matthew Livelsberger, died by suicide before the blast — highlights how car companies vacuum up reams of data that can clear up mysteries but also be stolen or given to third parties without drivers’ knowledge. There are few regulations controlling how and when law enforcement authorities can access data in cars, and drivers are often unaware of the vast digital trail they leave behind.

“These are panopticons on wheels,” said Albert Fox Cahn, who founded the Surveillance Technology Oversight Project, an advocacy group that argues the

SEE DATA ON A12

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